Patient name _____ Date _____

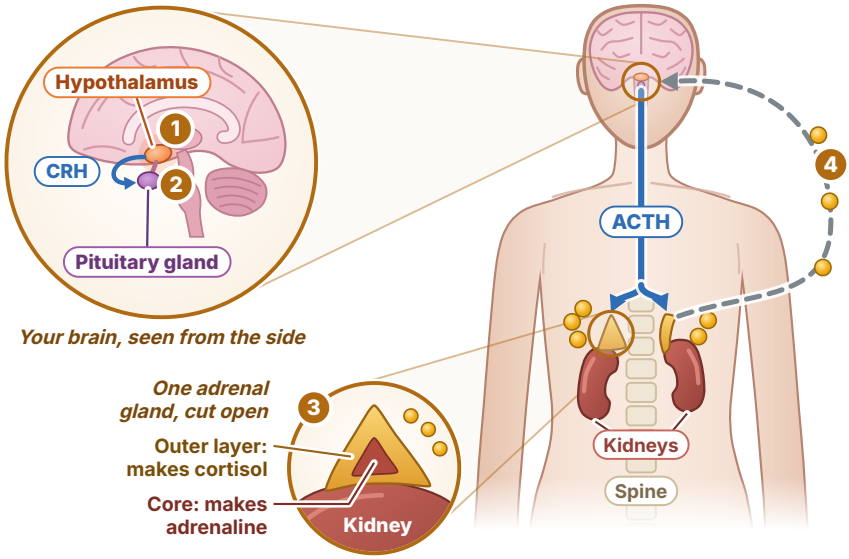
Stress and Cortisol

How your stress system works, and how to steady it

Your brain and **adrenal glands** answer every stress, from a deadline to a sleepless night, as one team: the **HPA axis**. Its messenger, the hormone **cortisol**, gives you fuel and focus, then switches off. When stress never lets up, the system stays on alert and your daily rhythm can flatten: **tired in the morning, wired at night**.

YOUR STRESS SYSTEM

the HPA axis: H for hypothalamus, P for pituitary, A for adrenal glands



1 THE ALARM
When stress hits, your hypothalamus, deep in the brain, sends out a signal called CRH.

2 THE RELAY
Your pea-sized pituitary gland answers with ACTH, which travels through the blood.

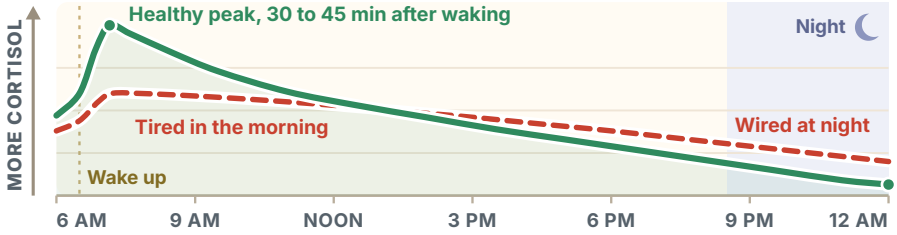
3 THE RESPONSE
Your adrenal glands, on your kidneys, release cortisol. It raises blood sugar for quick fuel.

4 THE BRAKE
Cortisol tells the brain to ease off. When stress never lets up, the alarm stays on.

KEY
- Blue arrow: a stress signal (CRH, ACTH)
- Gold dot: cortisol
- Grey dashed arrow: the brake
- Yellow: adrenal glands, on the kidneys

YOUR CORTISOL CLOCK

one day, two rhythms



GREEN LINE: HEALTHY RHYTHM
High soon after you wake, to get you going. Lowest near midnight, so you can sleep.

RED DASHED LINE: LONG STRESS
The curve can flatten: a smaller morning rise and higher evening levels.

Shapes after Debono 2009, Stalder 2016, Miller 2007

WHEN STRESS RUNS TOO LONG

tick the signs that fit you, then go over them with your provider

- ☐ Trouble sleeping
- ☐ Tired, even after sleep
- ☐ Headaches, tight muscles
- ☐ Foggy, hard to focus
- ☐ Anxious, cranky or low
- ☐ Upset stomach
- ☐ Sick more often
- ☐ Slow belly weight gain

Is it "adrenal fatigue"?

You may hear stress-tiredness called that, but it is **not a medical diagnosis**. A review of 58 studies found no proof that stress wears out the adrenal glands. What can change is your cortisol rhythm, and the daily habits on the back can help reset it.

See a doctor soon if you notice

Signs of too little cortisol
- Weight loss with deep tiredness
- Dizzy or faint when you stand
- Craving salt, darkening skin
- Nausea, vomiting or belly pain

Signs of too much cortisol
- A rounder, redder face with fast belly weight gain
- Wide purple stretch marks
- Easy bruising, weak thigh muscles
- New high blood pressure or blood sugar

On a steroid such as prednisone? Never stop it suddenly. **Thinking of harming yourself?** Call or text **988**, any time.

Sources: Endocrine Society guidelines (adrenal insufficiency 2016, 2024; Cushing's 2008); Pituitary Society 2021; Cadegiani 2016; Smith 2006; Miller 2007.

Steady Your Stress Response

Six daily habits that help reset your cortisol rhythm

Morning light
Get outdoors within an hour of waking.

Slow breathing
Five minutes a day of long, slow exhales.

Move daily
150 minutes a week. A brisk walk counts.

Protect sleep
7+ hours. Short nights raise cortisol.

Coffee by noon
Late coffee can cost you sleep.

Lean on people
Friends soften your stress response.

Nutrient Solutions

What your body needs, and the NutriDyn formula that delivers it

START HERE

Stress response
stress herbs (adaptogens)



Stress Essentials Cortisol Pro
60 capsules

- Supports a healthy stress response ◆
- Helps maintain healthy cortisol levels ◆

IN EACH SERVING
Per 2 capsules: 300 mg maral root, 250 mg Relora bark, 250 mg rhodiola, 150 mg ashwagandha, 100 mg L-theanine, 100 mg phosphatidylserine

2 capsules daily
with breakfast

Daytime energy
mushroom plus stress herbs



Stress Essentials Balance
90 or 180 capsules

- Supports energy and stamina under stress ◆
- Helps your body adapt to daily demands ◆

IN EACH SERVING
Per 3 capsules: 800 mg cordyceps, 400 mg ashwagandha (Sensoril), 107 mg Asian ginseng extract, 100 mg rhodiola, 58 mg ginseng root

3 capsules at breakfast
half the label dose

Quiet a busy mind
calming amino acids



Stress Essentials Calm
60 capsules

- Promotes a calm, relaxed mood ◆
- Helps you unwind in the evening ◆

IN EACH SERVING
Per 2 capsules: 500 mg GABA, 200 mg L-theanine
Formerly Calm Eze

2 capsules daily
in the evening

Restore magnesium
magnesium, inositol, taurine



Mag Calm Pro
About 60 servings
Raspberry Lemon

- Supports relaxation and restful sleep ◆
- Stress can use up magnesium

IN EACH SERVING
Per scoop: 200 mg magnesium, 2 g myo-inositol, 500 mg taurine, 100 mg L-theanine, 5 mg vitamin B6

1 scoop in 6 oz water
at bedtime

Coming off a glandular?
only if you already take one



Stress Essentials Adrenal Renew
60 capsules

- Replaces your current glandular (dried cow adrenal)
- B vitamins and vitamin C for a healthy stress response ◆

IN EACH SERVING
Per 2 capsules: 300 mg vitamin C, 50 mg B1, 15 mg B2, 60 mg B6, 50 mg B5, 15 mg zinc, 300 mg cow adrenal, 200 mg holy basil, 100 mg L-tyrosine, 50 mg cow spleen

2 capsules at breakfast
then step down as directed

YOUR DAILY RHYTHM

Morning
Stress Essentials Cortisol Pro 2 capsules
Stress Essentials Balance 3 capsules

Evening meal
Stress Essentials Calm 2 capsules

Bedtime
Mag Calm Pro 1 scoop

The full plan is **7 pills and 1 scoop a day**. Overwhelmed? Start with the **Start here** pick, then add one product a week.

PROVIDER CHECK

Keep taking your medicines.

- **Ashwagandha** (Cortisol Pro, Balance): 550 mg a day. It can make sleep, anxiety or thyroid pills stronger: tell your provider if you take any. Yellow skin or eyes, or dark urine? Stop both and call a doctor.
- **Adrenal Renew is a glandular** (dried cow adrenal): never with another. On prednisone, hydrocortisone or thyroid pills? Ask your provider first, and stop glandulars slowly.
- **On warfarin, an antidepressant, or diabetes or heart medicine?** Rhodiola, ginseng and holy basil can change how some of these work. Ask your provider first.
- **A day adds up to** 350 mg rhodiola and 400 mg L-theanine. With Adrenal Renew, B6 reaches 65 mg: tingling or numb hands or feet? Tell your provider.
- **Pregnant, trying to get pregnant or breastfeeding?** Skip Cortisol Pro and Balance, and ask your provider before the others.

Special considerations for you:

Recommended by _____ Phone _____

◆ **These statements have not been evaluated by the Food and Drug Administration. These products are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease.**

NutriDyn